GMS WEEKLY

Your Source for Recycling News

December 12th, 2025
Week 50
Volume 279, Issue 1215

Highlights:

- **Festive decline.**
- **Cheap Green.**
- **Supply boost.**
- **Bangla takes.**
- **HKC continues.**
- **Scan to download / view the Weekly on the GMS App!**

QUOTE of the WEEK

"A surplus of effort could overcome a deficit of confidence."

– Sonia Sotomayor

-- MARKET COMMENTARY --

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DECEMBER DOWNERS!

Markets across the board seem to be getting hit by the tragedies of 2025 as December firmly stamps its footprints across the 2025 ship-recycling timeline, ensuring the situation doesn't get a chance to improve just yet! Inflation is on the rise again, plate prices are collapsing in the wrong places, all while the U.S. Dollar continues to rummage through the wreckage of 2025 for whatever it can suck out of ship-recycling currencies and both freight rates & oil futures tumble in unison — just within the span of week 50.

To start, the Baltic Exchange Dry Index reportedly fell nearly 4%, down to its lowest level in nearly a month, dragged by capes that fell 5.6%. Panamax followed suit with a 2.1% drop, and smaller vessels wrapped up the cold blanket with a 16-basis-point drop as the cherry on top. And, surprising many industry traders, oil futures failed to hit the much-anticipated USD 60/barrel mark, instead retreating over 3% to USD 57.61/barrel as the week clocked out — amidst global fears primarily brought on by forecasts predicting an overproduction of oil. The International Energy Agency reaffirming its forecast for a "record supply glut."

Local steel plate prices seemed to slip on the spilling oil figures as they, too, followed suit with noteworthy drops of their own, compounded by slipping currencies as the U.S. Dollar continues to rattle major trading economies.

As the occasional introduction of a market vessel remains the carrot dangling at the end of a drying supply stick, Indian sub-continent ship-recycling markets were already declining, ensuring that the upcoming festive time may perhaps be the perfect moment to reflect and reset after an altogether inadequate and underwhelming few years of horrid supply and ever-declining levels. USD 600/ton was breached back in January 2024, and for a great majority—standing at the doorstep of 2026, and across all sub-continent locations—prices have dipped below the USD 400/ton mark.

While several green vessels have been sold cheaply into Bangladesh over recent weeks, prices here seem to have slipped off the back of a spate of recent deliveries pulling local levels down. Domestic turbulence is unfortunately on the rise in the small nation once again as the final election dates get announced. And although a healthy majority of the recent supply was squarely focused on a Bangladesh redelivery that has now slipped into the background—joining Indian and Pakistani recycling markets on their downward decline once again—evidence was across all the waterfronts this week, including a surprise.

Finally, HKC developments are ongoing in both Bangladesh and Pakistan, with another three yards expected to receive their HKC accreditations in Chattogram in the new year, while the next batch of yards in Pakistan are expected to follow within Q1 2026 — what a year in recycling it's truly been.

GMS demo rankings / pricing for week 50 of 2025 are on Page 6.

BANGLADESH

POST-FOREFRONT!

HKC green sales.

Chattogram has certainly been at the forefront of recent sales and deliveries, given how busy its waterfront has been throughout November, including a raft of green, HKC-only LNGs to select yards (four in total), a mini cape, and an MR tanker.

Prices suffer.

And although Bangladesh has remained the highest-priced destination in the market rankings for at least two months now, local recyclers found it pointless to their offerings when their currency was being frayed at the ends week-after-week and local steel plate prices regularly started to see the south side of last week's levels, compelling recyclers to lower their offerings – especially in the face of declining competitors. As such, the recent sales of these units at below-market prices sent overall vessel pricing across the entire Indian sub-continent reeling, as levels on conventional vessels across the board are increasingly seeing offers at or below USD 400/ton.

Waiting to reconcile.

With freight rates still high overall, and vintage '90s bulkers — and even some tankers — still sailing the high seas far longer than expected, it may well be a quieter Christmas/festive period in Bangladesh as end buyers digest some of the recent deliveries and reconcile not only where vessel prices will go, but where the nation overall will head in a post-election era. February 12, 2026, has now been confirmed as the next General Election Day, which will certainly oust this dysfunctional interim government and hopefully induce an economic resurgence that has been sorely lacking in Bangladesh since June 2024.

But anticipation of the upcoming election has also brought with it growing instances of political violence and instability that could make everyday life a hassle as we get closer to the election date — a not-so-uncommon feature of Bangladeshi politics.

Promising

As logical/meaningful indications all but disappear off the Bangladeshi end of the bidding tables, local anchorage continues to reflect the state of affairs with only one mid-sized LDT bulker greeting the waterfront this week. And while the currency — which only lost 1 basis point against the U.S. Dollar — could have offered "some" encouragement to the local mindset, it was collapsing local steel plate prices that essentially dictated the tone for local offerings, as they fell a massive USD 9/ton dropping below USD 502/ton from last week's close to the high USD 493s/ton this week.

Where the market goes from here as we wait for demand and levels to pick up again heading into the new year, remains to be seen- but Bangladesh is not a promising destination in the short run.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

INDIA

DISCOURAGING!

Lowest again.

As the lowest-placed Indian sub-continent ship-recycling destination for yet another week, it has been discouraging for Alang recyclers to see usually favoured green vessels heading to Bangladeshi shores rather than India over recent weeks, even while some above-market (for India) offers failed to swing certain vessels further West, despite local demand being relatively firm in the growing impossibility of securing any tonnage at all — so slow has the introduction of vessels been of late.

Unable to acquire.

And given the pitiful levels being tabled from Alang buyers, the number of local arrivals this week certainly highlighted the ongoing diet of tonnage that Alang recyclers are being forcefully fed, while being simultaneously tempted by the fact that far lower-priced, but questionable background units remain omnipresent and able for a quick pick-me.

The state of ongoing offer levels is clearly being dominated by local fundamentals that are in a seriously woeful state, as the already depressed level of local steel prices suffered another brutal hit, losing over USD 7/ton and pulling overall steel trading levels to USD 377/ton. But it has been the Indian Rupee that has been the apostle of misery for the local mindset, as it lost a massive (by recent standards) 65 basis points against the U.S. Dollar once again, closing the week out at a record-breaking INR 90.50.

Currency woes.

Stagflation territory, however, seems to be on a diet as inflation levels rose from 0.25% to 0.71% as November wrapped up, even though inflation remains at record-low levels and well below the Reserve Bank of India's tolerance threshold of 2%. With the Rupee getting ever weaker and local steel plate prices in the middle of a typhoon spin, perhaps this tonnage shortage is what this market needs to stabilize before profitable (for all) deals become the norm rather than the exception.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

PAKISTAN

BREATHTAKINGLY INERT!

Non serious.

Despite the recent announcement that Prime Green Recyclers became Pakistan's first HKC-ratified ship recycling yard, it has been an absolutely inert time for new (any?) business in Gadani as local recycling yards struggle to offer anywhere near acceptable levels for any of the sporadic candidates being offered locally. As a result, anything proposed at the bidding tables almost never greets the local waterfront, given this market's shortage of HKC yards and prevailing DASR approvals introducing their own set of hula-hoops to wiggle around in.

Vessels diverted.

Surprisingly, however, Gadani ended up being the donor of the surprise anchorage of the week, as—similar to all of its regional competition—local recyclers welcomed at least one smallish LDT unit that likely opened up in regional waters and decidedly wound up in Pakistan, as it would have received lower levels from India, along with a longer voyage and more expensive inward clearance to boot.

Fundamentals here, just like the overall state of global affairs, continue to decimate the ship recycling landscape. Even though an already high inflation improved slightly to 6.1% from 6.2% back in October, local steel plate prices (as in India) have been the deadweight dragging sentiments down of late. After weeks of relentless declines as the market continued to compete against cheaper Iranian imports, levels flatlined at a still-low USD 575/ton. The Pakistani Rupee too found stable footing as ended the week where it started, at PKR 280.35 against the U.S. Dollar.

Iranian imports.

As vigilance on ship recycling gains increasing global attention and Pakistan suffers its unfortunate fate of lagging behind on the HKC spectrum—and as shipowners worldwide grow increasingly cognizant of their final recycling destinations—even an increase in tonnage supply in 2026 might not alleviate Pakistan's depressed state.

Another slow year ahead for this market?

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

TURKEY

SLOW END?

Lira slipped another 26 basis against the U.S. Dollar and end the week at TRY 42.70 against the U.S. Dollar, all while import and local steel plate prices stabilized this week and the higher levels reportedly bought in no market tonnage this week. Viva 2026!

Viva 2026!.

NO MARKET SALES REPORTED

GMS Weekly – Market Rankings

For Week 50 of 2025, GMS Market Rankings / vessel indications are as below.

Rank	Location	Sentiment	Dry Bulk USD / LDT	Tankers USD / LDT	Containers USD / LDT
1	Bangladesh	**Weak**	410 / LDT	430 / LDT	440 / LDT
2	Pakistan	**Weak**	400 / LDT	420 / LDT	430 / LDT
3	India	**Weak**	380 / LDT	400 / LDT	410 / LDT
4	Turkey	**Steady**	270 / LDT	280 / LDT	290 / LDT

MOVIE WOWS!!

- *"Somewhere Over the Rainbow" was almost cut from The Wizard of Oz as MGM executives considered removing the scene because they thought it dragged down the film's momentum. They worried that the quiet moment would slow the story just as the plot was picking up speed. Some also felt the setting — a simple barnyard — didn't match the movie's big, colorful spectacle. On top of that, the song itself struck them as sad, and they feared audiences wouldn't respond well to something so melancholy, and that they wanted excitement and sparkle. Luckily, for all of us, the executives made the right choice in the end.*
- *Wicked was always meant to be a movie. Before it became a Broadway phenomenon, Universal had already acquired the rights to Gregory Maguire's 1995 novel with the intention of turning it into a film. However, producer Marc Platt struggled to adapt it into a screenplay, saying, "[It] felt that it was missing something." One day, he got a call from composer Stephen Schwartz, who knew he had the rights, and Schwartz asked him if he had ever thought of making it into a musical. That's when the "lightbulb went off" in his head, and Platt decided to work with Schwartz to make it into a musical. He thought that if the musical was successful enough, it could then be turned into a movie.*
- *When Alec Guinness agreed to play Obi-Wan Kenobi in Star Wars: A New Hope, he wasn't particularly excited about the project. Guinness thought the dialogue was clunky and the story was "fairy tale rubbish," but he found himself unable to put down the script. He agreed to do the film only after 20th Century Fox doubled their initial offer (paying him $ 300K) and to give him 2% of the film's box office royalties. George Lucas gave him an additional 0.5% after the film wrapped as a goodwill gesture. For his part, Guinness thought the film wasn't going to be a hit. When Star Wars became a massive global hit during its initial run, his share of the profits made him $7 million. By the time of his death in 2000, it is estimated that he had earned $95 million in residuals and royalties. His family continues to collect royalties from that role to this day.*

IMPORTANT DATES

INDIA	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
December 24 – Christmas Eve December 25 – Christmas Day December 31 – New Year's Eve	December 02 – December 10 December 18 – December 25

BANGLADESH	
BANK HOLIDAYS	**DELIVERY TIDES**
December 01 – 02 – Durga Puja December 16 – Victory Day December 25 – Christmas Day December 31 – Bank Holiday	December 03 – December 06 December 21 – December 24

BANK HOLIDAYS	
PAKISTAN	**TURKEY**
December 25 – Quaid-e-Azam	**No holidays in December**

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ALANG - Port Position as of December 12, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Conica Atlas	20,001	Oil Tanker	Arrived June 13
2	Nica	9,852	Oil Tanker	Arrived December 05
Morality		29,853		

CHATTOGRAM - Port Position as of December 05, 2025

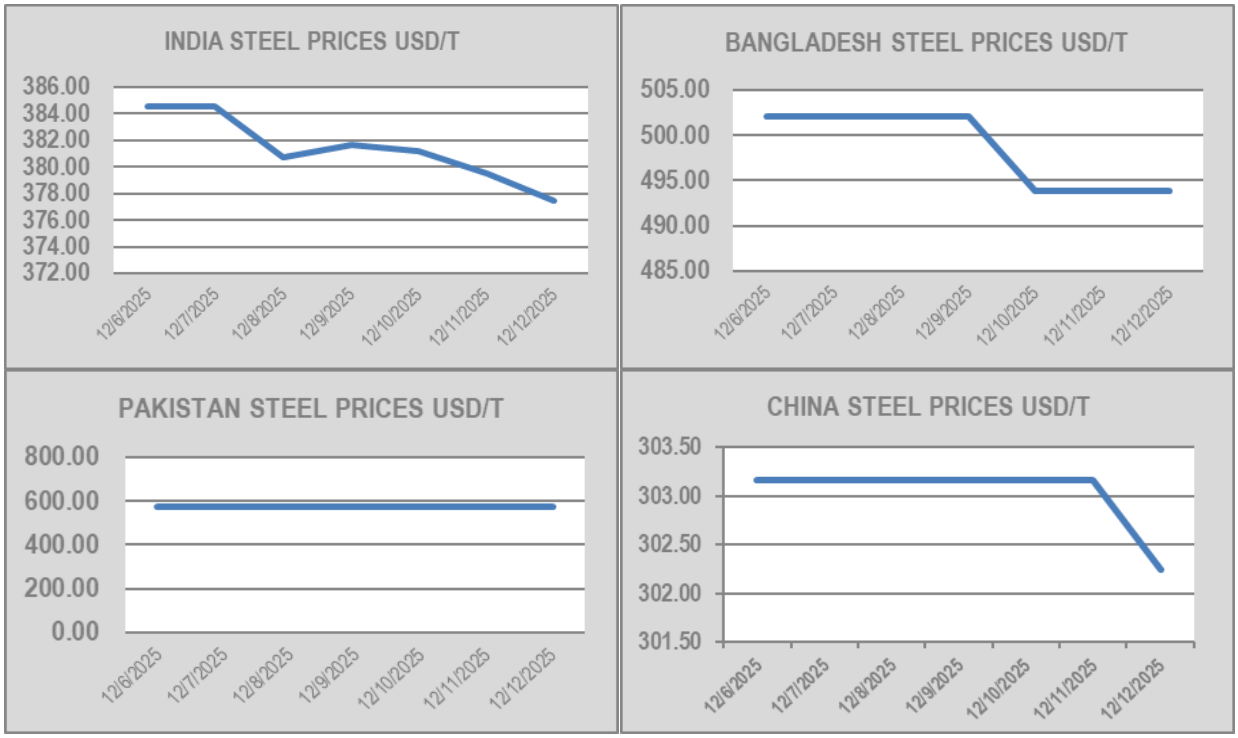
No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Fan Shun	7,690	Bulk Carrier	Arrived December 12
		7,690		

GADANI - Port Position as of December 12, 2025

No.	VESSEL NAME	LDT	TYPE	STATUS
1	Ardhianto	2,922	General Cargo	Arrived December 04
Total Tonnage		2,922		

WHILE EXTREME CARE HAS BEEN TAKEN IN THE PREPARATION OF THIS REPORT, NO LIABILITY CAN BE ACCEPTED FOR ANY LOSS INCURRED IN ANY WAY WHATSOEVER BY ANY PERSON RELYING ON THE INFORMATION CONTAINED HEREIN.

DATE	INDIA STEEL PRICES USD/T	INDIA STEEL PRICES	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES USD/T	PAKISTAN STEEL PRICES	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES USD/T	BANGLADESH STEEL PRICES	CHINA STEEL PRICES USD/T
12/6/2025	384.53	34,600.00	575.69	162,000.00	502.06	61,000.00	303.16
12/7/2025	384.53	34,600.00	575.69	162,000.00	502.06	61,000.00	303.16
12/8/2025	380.77	34,300.00	575.69	162,000.00	502.06	61,000.00	303.16
12/9/2025	381.62	34,300.00	575.69	162,000.00	502.06	61,000.00	303.16
12/10/2025	381.24	34,300.00	575.69	162,000.00	493.83	60,000.00	303.16
12/11/2025	379.55	34,300.00	575.69	162,000.00	493.83	60,000.00	303.16
12/12/2025	377.42	34,100.00	575.69	162,000.00	493.83	60,000.00	302.25



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